Who Am I (if not the me from yesterday)

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/41111085.

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General Audiences

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Catra & Glimmer (She-Ra)

Character:
Catra (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra)

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minor glimbow and catradora at the end, time travel sort of, talking to your past self, some hurt some comfort, a lot of stubbornness, Portal shenanigans, platonic glitra, AKA chaos duo

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Part 15 of Here We Are (after the war)

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by catrasredemption (dimensionhoppingrose)

Summary

"Something must have gone wonky with the portal," Catra whispered to Glimmer. "Maybe we accidentally—"

"*Portal*?" Oops. Catra wasn't used to other people being able to hear as well as she could. "What *portal*?"

Catra sighed, holding up her hands to turn to her younger self. "Entrapta's been trying to rebuild the portal so we can um...find and save Angella."

"*What*?!"

That was young Glimmer, her voice a furious screech. -OR- Glimmer and Catra accidentally meet their past selves. And realize how absolutely exhausting they were to deal with.

Notes

Honestly this idea was never supposed to be published, I just wrote it to be cathartic. Then I found the title in a potential ideas note on my phone and, well. Destiny or something.

See the end of the work for more notes

"I *told you* this was a bad idea!"

"I don't recall asking your opinion, Sparkles!"

"Well, you're getting it anyway!"

The women looked around uncertainly, grimacing. "Did we make it?" Glimmer asked after a moment, taking in the overwhelming *white* around them.

"I don't think so. Adora said it looked more like... you know, a rocky landscape. Not... white." *Not like the Horde Prime ship*. They were both thinking it, but neither wanted to say it.

"Great, so are we stuck somewhere else?"

Catra got her tablet out of her bag, tapping on it. "I'm still getting responses from Entrapta's pings, so I'm sure she can find us. It might just take awhile."

"Where do you think we *are*?"

"No clue." Catra nudged Glimmer with her shoulder, smirking. "Scared?"

"Just of how mad Adora and Bow are going to be when we get back," Glimmer shot back. "We should have told them."

"They would have tried to stop us."

"Yeah."

But maybe they *needed* to be stopped. Glimmer had known they were playing with fire, trying to open a portal to find her mother. Catra was *obsessed* with it—she'd spent days and weeks and *months* working herself tirelessly with Entrapta and the Hordaks to try and rebuild the portal. Glimmer knew there had been no stopping

her. So instead, she had insisted on accompanying her to make sure they stayed out of trouble.

"Do you think I can still teleport?" Glimmer asked curiously. Catra shrugged, and Glimmer decided to try. She felt the usual tingle of magic and sparkles, and she disappeared — then reappeared about a foot away from Catra. Not exactly what she had been hoping for.

"I don't think there's much we can do except wait for—"

"What the *fuck*?!"

They jumped, whirling to see a disturbingly familiar, yet unfamiliar face just a few feet away. Catra. Young, wild hair tamed back and tucked behind her mask, mismatched eyes wide. "Oh," present Catra said, blowing out a long breath. "That's uh... that's not good."

"What in the... what's going on?"

Another horribly familiar voice, and another face they definitely hadn't expected — Glimmer. Young Glimmer. A scared child hiding behind the mask of a queen.

"Oooooookay," present Glimmer said slowly, taking a step back toward *her* Catra. "We *definitely* messed something up."

"I mean, maybe not," Catra said weakly. "But... would you guys believe this is just a dream?"

"Two Catras?" young Glimmer scoffed. "More like a nightmare."

"I took the words right out of my mouth," young Catra muttered.

"See?" Catra said with a grin. "This'll be easy."

Glimmer sighed, shaking her head. "Okay. So this is going to sound weird, but uh... where... are you guys right now?"

"I think that's our question to *you*," young Catra said with no small amount of venom in her voice. Her claws were out, entire body rigid, muscles bunched. Right. This was Catra at her absolute worst. She wasn't going to be much help.

"Before you both ended up here," Catra corrected, waving a hand around them. "Like... were you trying to sleep, or?..."

Young Glimmer's shoulders slumped. "The um... the dinner with Horde Prime."

Young Catra looked away, expression hardening. Catra and Glimmer exchanged looks. "Oh," Glimmer said after a minute.

"The clones brought me back to my uh... cell." Young Glimmer's eyes flickered to young Catra. "Not sure what *she* did."

Catra knew. She'd wandered off after the dinner, shaken, and found a corner to curl up in and try to sleep. It had been broken at best, and she hadn't felt much better when she woke up.

"Something must have gone wonky with the portal," Catra whispered to Glimmer. "Maybe we accidentally—"

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Catra sighed, holding up her hands to turn to her younger self. "Entrapta's been trying to rebuild the portal so we can um... find and save Angella."

"*What*?!"

That was young Glimmer, her voice a furious screech. They all jumped, looking to her. "What are—are you—bullshit!" she finally managed to sputter out, furious. "*You're* trying to save my mother? You expect *anyone* to believe that?"

"Hey ," Glimmer scolded the young queen gently . "*I* believe it. Why do you think I'm here?"

"I don't know! Maybe this is just some... some weird hallucination. Or like, you're both from some messed up future where the Horde wins and you're here to try and manipulate me!"

"Oh, they're trying to manipulate *you*?" young Catra scoffed, waving a hand at her older self. "Look at *her*! If anyone is getting fucked with here, it's *me*!"

"Oh for fuck's sake," Catra muttered, covering her face with her hands. Of course they were both going to be stupid and stubborn. "And what's wrong with what I'm wearing?"

"Let's start with the *boots*."

"To be *fair* to me," Catra said patiently . "We didn't know what we were walking into. The boots are practical. I usually don't wear them unless it's a special occasion."

"You're worrying about *clothing*?" young Glimmer scoffed. "Why are you two *together*?"

"I'm already getting a headache," Catra muttered, pulling out her tablet to check in with Entrapta. Still nothing except the occasional ping. She must have been trying to get a lock on their location.

"Listen," Glimmer said as patiently as she could manage. "I know you guys are in a bad place right now, and kind of hate each other"—

"*Kind of?*" Young Glimmer's voice was dark with malice. "She *killed* my *mother*!"

Glimmer and Catra both saw young Catra wince and look away, fingers tightening into fists. "No," Glimmer said patiently . "She didn't. I'm made a choice."

"She wouldn't have had to if that *horde scum* hadn't pulled the lever to begin with!"

Young Catra hissed, ears flattening against her head. Catra blew out a long breath, closing her eyes. She'd gotten better at talking about the portal, but it was still hard to hear about, even while she was trying to fix it.

"Yeah," she said, opening her eyes. "You're right. I pulled the lever. It was all my fault."

Glimmer looked at her in shock. "Catra—"

"I pulled the lever," she continued, voice even. "I was angry, and I just wanted to watch the world burn. I looked Adora in the eye, I *lied*, and I pulled the lever."

Young Glimmer clenched her fists, eyes narrowing with each word. They were all surprised when she blasted Catra with magic, throwing her nearly ten feet away. Apparently *she* had her powers here, too. She disappeared and reappeared in front of Catra, hand out, ready to hit again. The magic hummed audibly, but nothing happened. Catra sat up, rubbing the back of her head, and looked up, meeting young Glimmer's gaze.

"Well, what are you waiting for? Do it."

They all watched as the young queen flinched back. "You can't, can you?" Catra's voice was low, but not mocking. Anyone who knew her would've heard the undertone of *caring* in her voice. "You couldn't in the Fright Zone, and you can't now. Because you're a *good* person, no matter how angry you are. You're good, and you can admit when you're wrong, and that's not a weakness. *You* taught me that." Catra pushed herself up, grimacing, and rubbed the back of her head. That had been quite the blow. "You showed me that it's never too late to make up for my mistakes. And there are a *lot* of mistakes in my past, don't get me wrong. I don't think I'll ever fully make up for them. But I'm trying. Because of you."

Glimmer smiled softly, looking back at young Catra. She'd been surprisingly quiet this entire time – or maybe not surprisingly. She had been very quiet for a lot of the time on Prime's ship. How long had they spent in silence together?

"I know this all seems *really* weird," Glimmer said as she approached young Catra, keeping her distance and showing her hands. "I hated you for a really, really long time. I blamed you for *him*, for everything. But soon – really, really soon – you're going to do something that's going to save my life, and I'm never really going to be able to thank you for it, or make up for what happened to you because of it all. But you showed me then what kind of person are, and you've been proving it every day since. You're one of my best friends, and the person I trust more than anyone else in the world. You're a *good* person underneath all the prickliness and attitude, and I know how lucky I am to be one of the few people you let see that. You're going to have such a good life, and be so happy – both of you are."

She looked back at her younger self, smiling. "And you only get that happy ending because of each other," Catra added. "Because you both saw past your stupidity and anger and stubbornness and saw someone worth risking your life for."

Young Glimmer looked at her older self, then back at Catra. Then her gaze zeroed in on something else – something on Catra's shirt. "Is that... Adora's Right Hand pin?"

Young Catra perked up slightly at the mention of Adora, gaze confused, but weary. Glimmer laughed, daring to rest her hands on young Catra's shoulders. "You're going to get *everything* you want, Catra. Trust me."

Young Catra's eyes widened slightly, and she let out a shaking breath. Her eyes dared to look at her future herself, then down at the boots again. She let out a long breath, and nodded.

Something beeped in Catra's bag;she pulled out the tablet, and let out a breath of relief. "Entrapta' s got a lock on us. Time to go, Sparkles."

"*Really* ?young Glimmer huf fed. Glimmer laughed as she walked back to Catra.

"m still Sparkles, she' s still Horde Scum. t' s all said with love, really."

"W ait,"young Catra spoke up. "W ont telling us all this mess up timelines or something?"

Glimmer and Catra exchanged looks. "W ell find out, Iguess,"Catra said after a moment. "Y ou guys said you were sleeping, right? Maybe this will all be some weird dream or something."

"T ry not to kill each other!"Glimmer added in a singsong voice, hooking her arms around one of Catra's.

"Or do. Really , whatever you guys want. We're not in charge of your lives."

Two bewildered looks were the last thing they saw before they were pulled back into the portal.

t wasn't a pleasant trip, and the floor of Entrapta' s lab was hard and cold. "ey both groaned, just laying there for a moment.

"Glimmer!"

"Catra!"

"en they were being dragged up by their spouses and hurriedly checked over. "*Entapta* ,"Catra groaned, scrubbing her eye with the heel of her palm. "Y ou weren't supposed to tell them."

"ey kind of just walked in,"Entrapta said with a shrug.

"What were you two *thinking*?" Bow demanded, patting Glimmer's cheeks and ignoring her trying to bat his hands off.

"What if you had gotten *hurt*?" Adora added, voice cracking with stress. Catra rolled her eyes, grabbing Adora's hands and kissing her cheek.

"It's *fine*, Adora. Stop worrying so much."

"Did you find anything?" Entrapta asked excitedly. Glimmer and Catra exchanged looks.

"Just a couple of brats."

They never looked at each other.

It was like an unspoken rule. Maybe they exchanged brief glances before taking their seats, backs against the force field separating them, but that was it. They didn't look at each other. If they looked, something would break.

Instead, they stared at the wall across from them, lost in their own thoughts with each other for company.

"Why do you keep coming back here?" Glimmer asked one day — how long had it been? Neither of them knew.

"I can go," Catra said, a bit snippishly. Glimmer was quickly learning that was just a cover up for whatever Catra was hiding.

"That's not what I said. I'm just curious."

No answer. Fine. Glimmer rested her head against the forcefield, sighing. Sure, her only company was *Catra*, and she sucked, but it was something.

At least they weren't alone in their punishments.

"You know," Glimmer said suddenly, breaking the silence again. "I had the weirdest dream last night. I don't remember all the details, but I think we were... friends?"

Catra snorted. "Sounds more like a nightmare."

"Right?" Glimmer laughed. It was the first time she had laughed since she'd gotten here, and it felt good. It felt *right* to share this moment with Catra. Friends? Definitely not. But grudging acquaintances in their quests to stay alive? That fit a little more.

"So if we're friends then I obviously get some kind of position in your court, don't I? I mean, Adora's your best soldier, and Bow is... what, your royal consort?"

Glimmer nearly choked on air. "*What?* He's my *friend*!"

"Really?" Catra sounded honestly surprised. "Okay, sure thing, Sparkles. Whatever you say."

"Oh shut up, Horde Scum."

It was almost… *almost* affectionate.

It was a start.

End Notes

Writers thrive off positive affirmations.

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!